

SAMUEL THONGORO MBOGO

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Investment professional with four years of progressive experience across blended finance, project finance, valuation, and corporate restructuring in East Africa. Currently structuring concessional and commercial capital for water service providers at KIFFWA, a blended-finance facility anchored by the Embassy of the Kingdom of the Netherlands (EKN), where I manage origination, due diligence, portfolio oversight, and institutional relationships across a growing pipeline of infrastructure transactions. Prior corporate finance advisory experience at RSM Eastern Africa spans debt capital raising, valuation, and turnaround mandates cumulatively exceeding USD 400 million across manufacturing, real estate, healthcare, education, food, and agribusiness in Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, Mauritius, and Indonesia.

Core strengths sit at the intersection of financial modelling, transaction structuring, and stakeholder engagement: translating complex capital structures into executable transactions, appraising blended concessional finance against sponsor and donor return expectations, and cultivating the DFI, donor, and co-investor relationships that determine whether a deal actually closes. Comfortable operating across the full transaction lifecycle — origination and Quick Scan triage, due diligence and regulatory cross-checks, financial modelling and valuation, Investment Committee papers, sponsor negotiation and legal coordination, and portfolio monitoring through to exit.

CAREER NARRATIVE

My career has traced a deliberate arc from accounting and finance operations into the structural end of capital markets. I began in claims and accounting internships, learned outsourced finance operations at KKCO where I ran full finance-function support for a fintech client, and moved into transaction advisory at RSM Eastern Africa — where I earned Project Senior responsibilities inside a Semi Senior grade, owning modelling output and client delivery on mandates ranging from a USD 12 million paper-manufacturing debt raise to a USD 150 million pharmaceutical industrial park.

At KIFFWA I now sit on the deployment side of that same capital stack, working on how concessional and commercial funding actually reaches water service providers in Kenya. The work runs from origination and due diligence at one end to structuring, IC advisory, and exit management at the other, alongside institutional-level work on KIFFWA's own next-phase capital strategy. The through-line across both chapters has been the same: producing analysis that is defensible in front of an Investment Committee, a donor, or a court.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Debt Capital Structuring & Blended Finance

Structuring concessional, commercial, and blended debt transactions for infrastructure clients. Working knowledge of first-loss tranches, guarantees, subordinated loans, catalytic grants, and layered facility models. Familiar with the DFI Enhanced Principles for the Use of Blended Concessional Finance and their application to co-investment structuring.

Asset Management & Portfolio Oversight

Portfolio monitoring, investment appraisal, and Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning (MEL) for water infrastructure projects. Portfolio-return metric design (MOIC over IRR for patient-capital contexts), pipeline management, and alignment of capital deployment with fund-level investment objectives.

Origination, Due Diligence & Investment Appraisal

End-to-end Quick Scan triage of inbound project proposals against mandate fit, technical viability, sizing, and SDG alignment. Regulatory and sector cross-checks (WASREB Impact Reports for Kenyan water utilities, K-WASH compliance data) used to validate or challenge sponsor-submitted projections.

Financial Modelling & Valuation

3-statement, project finance, and DCF modelling with scenario, sensitivity, and stress-testing overlays. Valuations using DCF, NAV, and comparable-multiples methods. FAST modelling-standard compliance for fund-level and project-level models. Models built for transactions ranging from USD 12 million debt raises to USD 150 million industrial parks.

Transaction Structuring & Exit Management

Exit valuation modelling for portfolio SPV equity stakes, with tailored analytical outputs for Investment Committee, external buyer, and Management Committee audiences. Coordination of legal counsel on exit mechanics including regulatory lock-in provisions, transfer restrictions, and tax structuring (stamp duty, CGT).

Investment Committee Reporting

Preparation of Investment Committee papers and presentation scripts covering originations, exits, and non-performing loan recoveries. Drafting of executive recommendations for the CEO on third-party advisory and partnership proposals.

Stakeholder & Institutional Relationship Management

Direct working relationships with development finance institutions, foundations, multilaterals, and technical partners. Meeting facilitation, concept-note development, and formal minute-taking through to countersignature across active partnership tracks with the African Water Facility, CEWAS, Pharo Foundation, UNICEF, CARE International, Adelphi, and Norfund.

Distressed Asset Workout & Restructuring

Loan recovery strategy, financial restructuring, and turnaround support for distressed positions. Prior court-mandated administration experience including Statement of Affairs (SOA) budget modelling and creditor reporting.

Forensic Investigation

Asset tracing, balance-sheet reconstruction, and quantification of salvageable assets across pre-administration financials, court proceedings, and management inputs.

Strategic Planning & Fund Structuring

Multi-year strategic plan development for blended-finance facilities. Analysis of fund structuring options (GP/LP conversion, layered facility, Separately Managed Account models) against DFI capital access, governance, and mandate constraints.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Investment Analyst — KIFFWA

Oct 2025 – Present

Kenya Innovative Finance Facility for Water | Nairobi, Kenya | Blended finance facility mobilising concessional, grant, and commercial capital to scale water service providers in Kenya. Anchored by EKN.

Origination & Pipeline Management

- Built and maintain an Excel-based deal pipeline tracker covering all inbound project proposals from initial triage through Quick Scan review, deep dive, and Investment Committee advancement.
- Lead first-look triage across a diverse inbound flow including standalone water infrastructure projects, county-promoted SPVs, hotel-cluster wastewater pilots, gravity-fed rural water supply schemes, and integrated logistics/desalination proposals sitting in adjacent sectors.
- Recent triaged inbound: county-promoted seawater desalination (Mombasa SWRO, Shimo La Tewa), private-SPV wastewater pilot (North Coast Hotels Cluster, Haller Park), spirulina/aquaculture gravity water supply (Nasaru Naturals, Kajiado), integrated livestock-desalination (Jibril Group, Lamu), and community water supply (West Kanyada, Homa Bay).

Due Diligence & Quick Scan Reviews

- Lead due diligence and screening of investment proposals against KIFFWA's mandate, technical viability, sizing, and SDG 6 alignment, including identifying mandate misalignment in proposals where stated SDG framing did not match the underlying project logic.
- Conducted a WASREB Impact Report cross-check (Issues 16–18, FY2022/23–FY2024/25) on a Quick Scan applicant utility, surfacing a 15.8-point year-on-year fall in Creditworthiness Index, declining O&M cost coverage, a data-reliability flag on volatile connection counts, and metering/collection ratios materially below the applicant's base-case model assumptions — leading to a hold-and-clarify recommendation ahead of Investment Committee.
- Applied a consistent evaluation framework across county-promoted SPVs and private SPV structures, including assessment of concessional-return mechanics against non-profit-distributing revenue structures, IP encumbrance on legacy feasibility studies, regulatory (WASREB) licensing pathways, and evidence quality on offtake assumptions.

Transaction Structuring & Exit Valuation

- Delivered exit valuation for a 27.5% equity stake in a portfolio hydropower SPV, iterating through three model versions and producing a final simplified workbook with three tailored analytical write-ups — for the Investment Committee, for prospective external buyers, and for the Management Committee.
- Coordinating with external legal counsel on exit-transaction mechanics, including PPA-triggered shareholder lock-in provisions, voluntary transfer versus company buy-back routing, stamp duty and CGT liability, and Registrar filing timelines.
- Prepared Investment Committee presentation scripts for a non-performing concessional loan recovery, including options analysis and recommended recovery pathway.

Investment Committee Reporting

- Prepare Investment Committee papers and presentation materials covering originations, exits, and recoveries.
- Assess third-party advisory and partnership proposals — including a Fund Launch Partners GP-eligibility evaluation and an Anza Capital partnership assessment — drafting executive recommendations for the CEO.

Project Implementation & Portfolio Coordination

- Coordinate biweekly Project Implementation Committee (PIC) engagements with portfolio companies, regulators, and co-financiers, including a live water-kiosk deployment partnership with Amref Kenya (Mbooni Watermart Limited): implementation progress, smart meter calibration, pipeline performance, kiosk branding, county government engagement, and launch planning.
- Advised on portfolio return-metric selection, recommending MOIC (Multiple on Invested Capital) over IRR as the headline return metric to align reporting with the facility's patient-capital positioning.

Sponsor Negotiation & Formal Record-Keeping

- Serve as sponsor-facing point of contact on multi-round Quick Scan revisions, drafting and countersigning formal meeting minutes through to sponsor countersignature. Managed a full revise-and-resubmit cycle with a private-sector sponsor, incorporating sponsor-proposed corrections into a second version, softening framing where warranted, and shepherding the record to full execution by both parties.

Business Development & Programme Partnering

- Cultivate co-financing and programme-partnership relationships with development finance institutions, foundations, and multilaterals spanning project development through follow-on scale-up stages.
- Active engagements: the African Water Facility (concept-note process, action-tracking); CEWAS (Majifund structure, Water Resilience Solutions Hub collaboration); Pharo Foundation (viability gap financing and CSR partnership angles); UNICEF (joint-programme collaboration); CARE International and Adelphi (early-stage relationships built through the AISA event circuit).

Institutional Finance & Capital-Flow Analysis

- Analyse capital-flow trends among development finance institutions to identify sector-allocation opportunities created by shifting donor policy mandates toward water and climate infrastructure.
- Translate direct DFI engagement into structural input on KIFFWA's next-phase capital strategy — including Norfund's fund-level due diligence feedback on first-time fund status, geographic concentration, and ticket-size mismatch — feeding these findings back into strategic plan and fund-structure decisions.
- Analysed a business development proposal from Madison Investment Managers, evaluating treasury management and blended finance implications for KIFFWA's operations.

Strategic Planning & Fund Modelling (KIFFWA III, 2027–2031)

- Contributed to KIFFWA's next-phase strategic plan (KIFFWA III, 2027–2031), reviewing four draft strategy documents and a financial projections workbook, identifying numerical inconsistencies, and producing a polished 58-page final document for presentation to the facility's anchor funder.
- Rebuilt the KIFFWA III financial model to FAST modelling standards, surfacing cashflow constraints that the prior version had obscured and materially changing the picture available to strategic decision-makers.
- Contributed structural analysis on fund-form options — full GP/LP conversion, layered facility, Separately Managed Account (SMA), and guarantee-instrument overlays — informing the working recommendation that KIFFWA III should formalise a layered facility or SMA model rather than a full GP/LP structure.

Corporate Finance Semi Senior — RSM Eastern Africa Consulting Ltd

Nov 2023 – Apr 2025

Nairobi, Kenya | Held Semi Senior grade contractually, with Project Senior responsibilities on engagements highlighted below — owning client delivery, modelling output, and team supervision.

- Led financial modelling, valuation, and capital-raising mandates spanning manufacturing, healthcare, real estate, education, and agribusiness across Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, Mauritius, and Indonesia.
- Delivered project finance, restructuring, valuation, and forensic mandates summarised in Selected Project & Transaction Highlights below.
- Supervised junior team members on modelling execution and quality control.

Finance and Business Advisory Associate — KKCO East Africa LLP

Jan 2023 – Oct 2023

Nairobi, Kenya

- Delivered outsourced finance operations and advisory for fintech and SME clients, including full finance-function support for Pesalink Finance — managed accounts payable and receivable, payroll for 50+ employees, tax filings, month-end close, and management reporting to the board.

Financial Analyst — Smart Farmer Financial Advisory

Aug 2022 – Dec 2022

Nairobi, Kenya

- Built 3-statement financial models with scenario and sensitivity analysis for 10+ agribusiness clients pursuing loan and grant funding; prepared business cases and pitch decks for capital applications.

Finance and Accounting Intern — Acorn Management Services Limited

Oct 2020 – Dec 2020

- Processed 100+ monthly invoices for office, property, and project expenses; billed residents and maintained P&L, prepayment, and accrual schedules across student-hostel real estate development.

Accounting and Claims Intern — NHIF Westlands

Jan 2020 – Mar 2020

Nairobi, Kenya

SELECTED PROJECT & TRANSACTION HIGHLIGHTS

KIFFWA — Water Infrastructure & Blended Finance

Hydropower SPV Exit Valuation | KIFFWA Lead Analyst, Exit Valuation & IC Advisory | 27.5% equity stake in a portfolio hydropower project

- Built exit valuation model in three iterations, culminating in a simplified fourth version with three distinct analytical write-ups tailored to Investment Committee, external-buyer, and Management Committee audiences.
- Coordinating exit execution with external legal counsel on PPA-triggered lock-in timing, voluntary transfer routing, and tax mechanics.

Non-Performing Concessional Loan Recovery | KIFFWA Lead Analyst, Restructuring & IC Advisory | Portfolio recovery case

- Prepared Investment Committee presentation script covering the current position, recovery-pathway options, and recommended action.

Utility Creditworthiness Cross-Check | KIFFWA Due Diligence Analyst | Kenyan county-based water service provider Quick Scan

- Cross-checked applicant's financial projections against three consecutive WASREB Impact Reports (FY2022/23–FY2024/25), surfacing a 15.8-point year-on-year fall in the Creditworthiness Index, declining O&M cost coverage, and metering/collection ratios materially below base-case assumptions — leading to a hold-and-clarify recommendation ahead of Investment Committee.

Integrated Sponsor Proposal Review | KIFFWA Sponsor Point of Contact & Analyst | Multi-round Quick Scan revision with private-sector sponsor group, Lamu County

- Managed the full revise-and-resubmit cycle with the sponsor after initial mandate-fit concerns, holding two rounds of countersigned minutes to formal execution and negotiating scope and cost-line adjustments to bring water access into the core of the proposal.

County Pipeline Onboarding | KIFFWA Due Diligence Analyst | Five-project county-linked pipeline (Coastal Kenya)

- Reviewed a portfolio-scale inbound pack from a county investment agency covering desalination, wastewater treatment, housing, MICE precinct, and MRF projects; produced preliminary continue/hold recommendations distinguishing between the two water-sector Quick Scans on structural and investment-readiness grounds.

RSM Eastern Africa — Corporate Finance & Advisory

Project Stationer — Regional Paper Manufacturing Group | RSM Lead Financial Modeller | Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, Mauritius | Outcome: USD 12 million raised.

- Conducted in-depth analysis of consolidated financials for the parent and seven subsidiaries over a five-year horizon.
- Designed and built a comprehensive financial model with stress-testing across multiple scenarios to validate financial resilience.
- Prepared management for IC inquiries and supported negotiations with debt financiers; secured USD 12 million for the group's expansion strategy.

Project Cure — Pharmaceutical Industrial Park | RSM Project Finance Analyst | Kenya | Project size: USD 150 million capital outlay.

- Developed a 10-year, 3-statement project finance model covering 12 distinct asset classes including vaccine fill-and-finish, full value chain (DSM), sterile and non-sterile pharmaceuticals, diagnostics, contract manufacturing, and shared services (ETP, warehousing, logistics).
- Formulated assumptions per asset class against industry benchmarks; stress-tested for cost overruns and revenue delays; consolidated outputs into a unified investor-ready view of park economics.

Metal Manufacturing Turnaround | RSM Business Analyst, Restructuring | Nairobi and Mombasa, Kenya

- Supported the administration and turnaround of an aluminium manufacturing plant under court-mandated administration.
- Built a budget model compliant with Statement of Affairs (SOA) requirements; led monthly, quarterly, and annual reporting to the bank and stakeholders.
- Investigated discrepancies and benchmarked operations against local and global industry standards, contributing to the plant's successful turnaround.

Project Clinic — Multi-Industry Group Stake Sale | RSM Project Senior, Valuation and Consolidation | Kenya

- Consolidated and valued three groups of companies — healthcare (5 subsidiaries), pharmaceutical manufacturing (3 subsidiaries), and clinical operations (2 subsidiaries) — for the divestment of a silent partner's stake.

Project Mart — Forensic Investigation | RSM Forensic Investigator | Kenya

- Constructed a dynamic balance sheet tracing asset base erosion across pre-administration financials, court proceedings, and management inputs to quantify salvageable assets supporting debt resolution for a regional supermarket chain.

Project Light — Cross-Border Deal Advisory | RSM Project Senior, Deal Advisory | Nairobi, Kenya and Tangerang, Indonesia

- Sourced and evaluated acquisition targets in Nairobi for an Indonesian education foundation expanding into East Africa.

Various Valuation Mandates | RSM Project Senior, Valuation | Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania | Cumulative deal value exceeding USD 250 million.

- Conducted valuations using DCF, NAV, and comparable multiples methods for transactions across agriculture, education, manufacturing, and food sectors.

Policy Advisory — NGO Finance and HR | RSM Risk Advisory Associate | Nairobi, Kenya

- Reviewed existing finance and HR policies and procedures and recommended updates aligned with industry best practices.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Commerce, Finance — University of Nairobi

2018 – 2022

Second Class Honours, Upper Division

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Public Accountant — CPA(K) | Institute of Certified Public Accountants of Kenya (ICPAK) | Member No. 32868
- Certified Investment and Financial Analyst (CIFA), Advanced Level | Institute of Certified Investment and Financial Analysts of Kenya (ICIFA) | In progress
- Financial Modelling and Valuation Analyst (FMVA) | Corporate Finance Institute (CFI)
- Business Intelligence and Data Analyst (BIDA) | Corporate Finance Institute (CFI)
- Financial Modelling in Renewable Energy | Arriba Financial Institute
- Africa Impact Investing Fellowship (AIIF) | AVPA and PFIC Social Impact Investors

TECHNICAL SKILLS & TOOLS

- **Financial Modelling:** Advanced Microsoft Excel — Scenario Manager, Solver, Data Tables for sensitivity analysis, Goal Seek, pivot tables, Power Query, Power Pivot, array formulas, INDEX-MATCH, XLOOKUP, and financial function libraries (XNPV, XIRR, PMT, RATE). Applied to 3-statement models, DCF valuations, project finance models, and fund-level cashflow models built to FAST modelling standards.
 - **Data Analysis & Programming:** Python — pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, matplotlib, seaborn, statsmodels, scipy, plotly, openpyxl, xlswriter, requests, BeautifulSoup, SQLAlchemy, Jupyter notebooks. Applied to financial data analysis, statistical modelling, web scraping, and workflow automation.
 - **Data Visualisation & Business Intelligence:** Power BI, Tableau, and advanced Microsoft Excel dashboards for portfolio reporting, management reporting, and client-facing data presentations.
 - **ERP & Accounting Systems:** Sage X3 Evolution, Xero, QuickBooks — experience across full-cycle accounting, payroll, tax compliance, and management reporting.
 - **Automation:** Excel VBA macros for report generation, data cleaning, and model automation; Python scripts for file processing, data pipelines, and batch analysis.
 - **Presentation & Design:** Microsoft PowerPoint, Canva — pitch decks, teasers, investment memoranda, and IC presentations.
 - **Financial Databases & Research:** Aswath Damodaran's NYU Stern datasets (country risk premiums, industry betas, cost of capital, ERP estimates, valuation multiples), FRED, World Bank Open Data, IMF WEO Database, Kenneth French Data Library, SEC EDGAR, African Development Bank Data Portal, KNBS, Central Bank of Kenya statistical releases, OECD Data, Trading Economics, Macrotrends, SimFin, OpenBB Terminal.
 - **Sector-Specific Sources:** WASREB Impact Reports and K-WASH compliance data for Kenyan water utility performance and creditworthiness benchmarking.
 - **Collaboration & Productivity:** Slack, Notion, Microsoft Teams.
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INDUSTRY COVERAGE

Water and Sanitation Infrastructure • Renewable Energy (Hydropower, Solar) • Manufacturing (Pharmaceuticals, Metals, Paper, Food) • Financial Services and Fintech • Real Estate and Construction • Healthcare • Education • Agriculture and Agribusiness • Oil and Gas • Retail • NGO and Development Sector

FOCUS AREAS

Depth-building across three intersecting themes:

- **Debt Capital Structuring for African Water Infrastructure** — concessional-and-commercial capital stacks, first-loss tranches, guarantee instruments, and project preparation facilities in a sector where the annual global investment gap is estimated in the hundreds of billions of dollars.
 - **Blended Finance Governance & Additionality** — application of the DFI Enhanced Blended Finance Principles to co-investment structuring, and the practical governance decisions faced by first-time funds seeking DFI capital.
 - **Regulatory-Financial Bridging in East African Utilities** — translating regulator-published operational data (WASREB, K-WASH) into inputs that materially change the credit picture at Quick Scan stage.
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LEADERSHIP & DEVELOPMENT

- Mentor — Phoenix Analytics | Jun 2024 – Mar 2025
 - Public Speaker — Toastmasters International, Downtown Nairobi | Mar 2023 – Feb 2024
 - Team Leader, Outgoing Global Volunteer — AIESEC, University of Nairobi | Feb 2021 – Oct 2022
 - Attendee — Africa Impact Investing Fellowship (AIIF), where water-sector expertise contributed into multinational team engagements.
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REFERENCES

Available on request.